

STUDENT SPEECH AND EXPRESSION

Students have the right to freedom of speech and expression during instructional and non-instructional time, both inside and outside classrooms or other areas where instruction is occurring. Such freedom of speech includes oral and written communications, student advocacy for social or political causes, and communications in different formats such as in publications, on clothing, or through electronic/digital/social media. This right does not extend to or include speech or other expressive conduct that violates [Policy 8210](#), Introduction to Student Discipline, and/or that leads to, or is likely to lead to, substantial disruption or material interference with instructional time, school activities or an invasion of the rights of others.

[Former Policy 8-61]

Adopted: 9/13/76

Revised: 6/22/93; 6/23/09

Current Revision: 09/10/24

Legal Reference: Code of Virginia § [18.2-390](#), § [18.2-372](#)

Cross Reference: [Policy 8270](#) (Student Dress Code); [Policy 8360](#) (School Publications – Digital and/or Print); [Policy 8210](#) (Introduction to Student Discipline)